

DELHI | Surgical Precision



of the 290-km Indo-Russian BrahMos missiles, which form one missile group in the army, are like sledgehammers. They fly at twice the speed of sound and a 300-kg warhead means the massive three-tonne missile can never be used in a populated area without the possibility of causing massive collateral damage. Following the 26/11 Mumbai attacks and the possibility of surgical strikes across the border, this matters. Thanks to higher computing speeds, BrahMos Block-2 is able to distinguish between a clutter of targets and home in on a single target. Or, as an army official puts it, "get a sledgehammer to perform the work of a scalpel".

by Sandeep Unnithan

The Indian Army just helped itself to a little more long-range muscle. With two successful tests of the Block-2 version of the BrahMos supersonic cruise missile in Pokhran, the army now has the capability to hit targets with minimum collateral damage. The existing variants

AHMEDABAD | Fall from Grace

The 2002 Gujarat riots returned to haunt the Sangh Parivar last week when the Gujarat High Court cancelled the anticipatory bail of former Gujarat minister of state for women's welfare

Mayaben Kodnani and VHP leader Jaydeep Patel in the infamous Naroda Patiya case. Ninety Muslims were killed by Hindu mobs in Naroda Patiya during the Gujarat riots of 2002. Kodnani was subsequently forced to resign. The duo, who have now been charged with inciting the Hindu mob, claim that the charges have been manipulated by Left-oriented human rights activists. The BJP leadership, though, has chosen a discreet silence.

by Uday Mahurkar



KODNANI (LEFT) AND PATEL

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